

READ THIS FIRST - printing, transferring, punching, setting

1 PRINT AT 100%

Print every page at 100% / Actual Size. Turn OFF "fit to page", "shrink to fit" and "scale to paper size" - they are on by default in most print dialogs and they are the single most common way a template comes out the wrong size.

Then go to page 2 and measure the scale bars before you cut anything.

2 ASSEMBLE THE 3 TILES

The full-size template is split across 3 pages (3 to 5), side by side, left to right. Every seam is vertical, so there is one line of tape per joint.

Trim the first tile along its right-hand TRIM LINE, lay it over the next page so the + registration marks sit exactly on top of each other, and tape the overlap. Each seam has two + marks, one near the head and one near the tail: get both onto their partners or the joint can pivot.

Work left to right, then check the assembled length against the flat-piece dimension printed on the template (438 mm).

3 TRANSFER TO LEATHER

You need a piece at least 450 x 224 mm (17.7 x 8.8 in) to have something to hold on to.

Cut the paper template out and lay it OUTSIDE FACE UP on the grain side of the leather. The outline is a symmetric rounded rectangle, so it traces the same either way up - but the flap must end up on the BACK cover, so keep track of which panel is which.

Mark the corners and the four fold lines lightly with a scratch awl, and prick all 13 hole centres through the paper.

4 PUNCH THE HOLES - BEFORE YOU CREASE

2.5 mm round punch for the 12 elastic holes, 3 mm for the single closure hole. A folded panel will not sit flat under a punch, so all punching happens while the piece is still flat. Punch into end grain or a poly board.

The dotted ring around each hole is the eyelet FLANGE footprint, drawn at 5.5 mm. Set one eyelet in a scrap first and measure its flange: if yours is wider than 5.5 mm, neighbouring flanges will touch and you should open the spacing in the build script before cutting the real piece.

5 SET THE EYELETS

12 eyelets at 2.5 mm for the elastics, 1 at 3 mm for the closure. Set from the OUTSIDE so the finished flange shows on the outside of the spine and the rolled side sits inside where the inserts run.

Work from the middle of each cluster outward, and check the piece stays flat - a spine with 12 eyelets in it will bow if you over-set them.

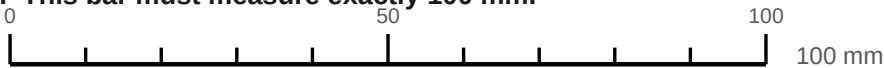
6 CREASE, THEN ASSEMBLE

Dampen the grain slightly and run a bone folder along a straight edge on each of the three solid fold lines. Fold away from the grain side.

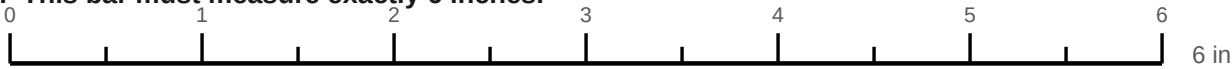
Closure elastic first, then the three insert elastics. Each one goes out through the INNER hole of a cluster, across the 7 mm bar, back in through the OUTER hole, stopper knot inside.

SCALE CHECK - measure these before you cut anything

A. This bar must measure exactly 100 mm.

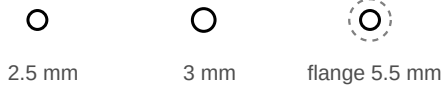


B. This bar must measure exactly 6 inches.



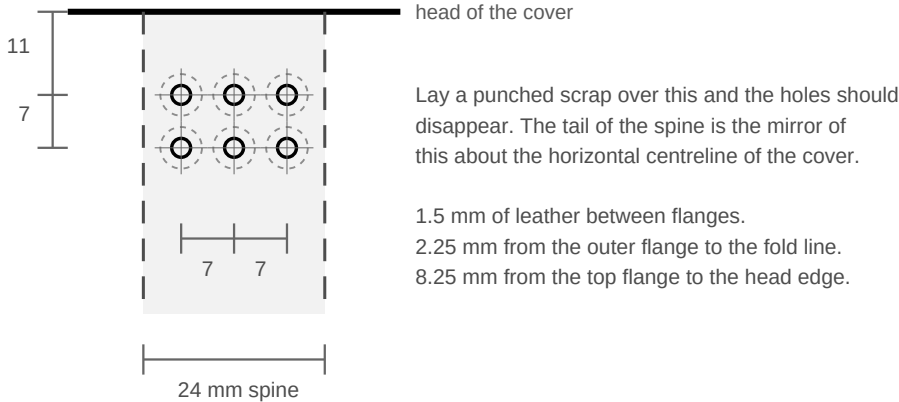
If either bar is short, your print dialog scaled the page. Reprint at 100% / Actual Size with "fit to page" off. Do not try to compensate by cutting slightly bigger.

C. Holes and eyelet flanges, shown at true size.



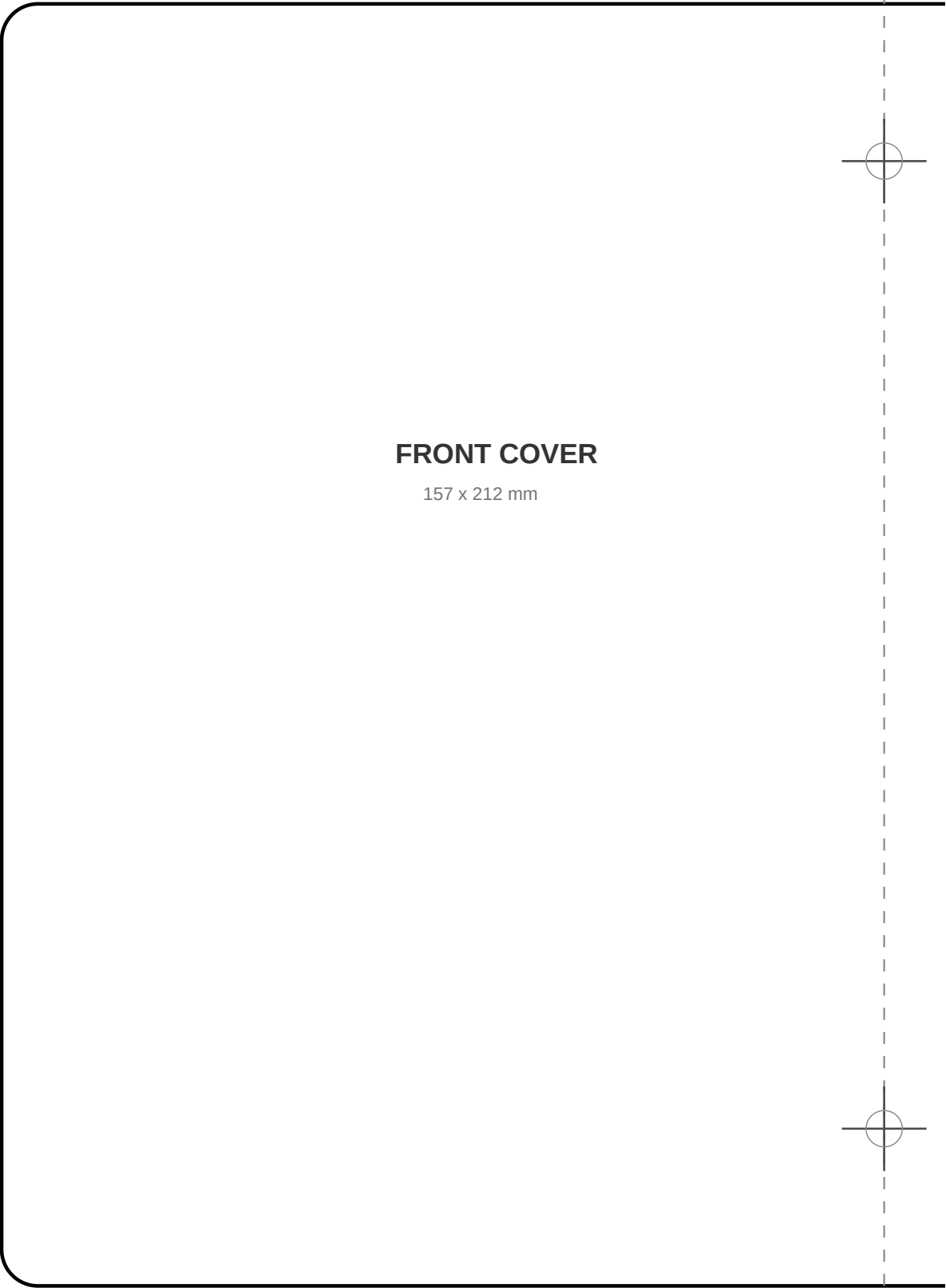
Drop one of your own eyelets on top of the dotted ring. If its flange is wider than 5.5 mm the spacing in this template is too tight - see the tuning notes in the guide.

D. Top of the spine at true size - punch layout.



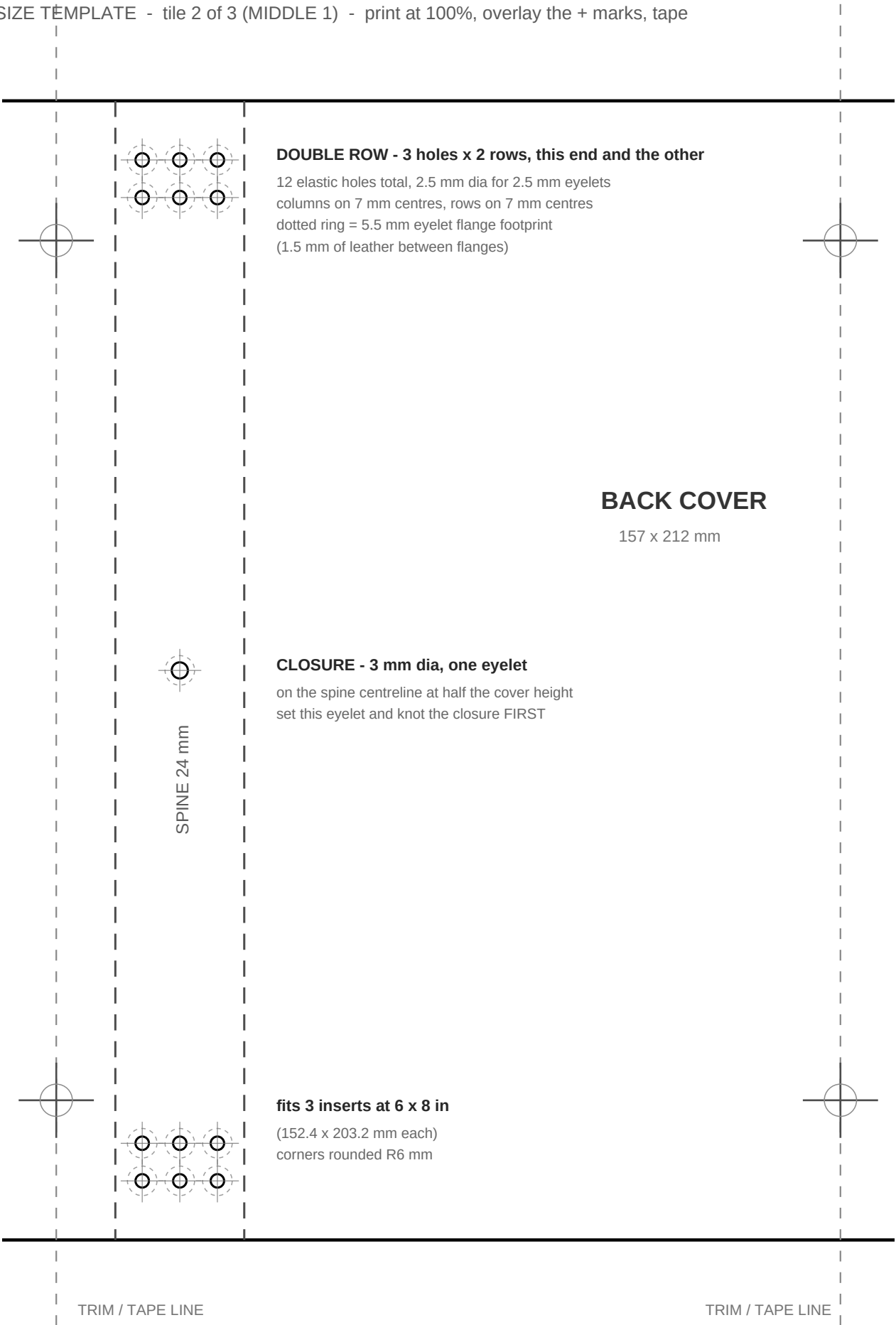
FULL-SIZE TEMPLATE - tile 1 of 3 (LEFT) - print at 100%, overlay the + marks, tape

OUTSIDE FACE UP - A5 trifold cover V2 - flat piece is 438 x 212 mm



TRIM / TAPE LINE

FULL-SIZE TEMPLATE - tile 2 of 3 (MIDDLE 1) - print at 100%, overlay the + marks, tape



FULL-SIZE TEMPLATE - tile 3 of 3 (RIGHT) - print at 100%, overlay the + marks, tape

